

DigiT — Region & Language Detection

Knowing where a user is, and prompting them to switch language by region · v1.0

How does DigiT know a user is from a different part of the world, and offer to switch language? The key insight is that these are **two different questions** — *where is the user* (region) and *what language do they want* — and each is answered by a different signal. Conflating them is the classic mistake (a Punjabi speaker in Germany; an American travelling in India).

The rule that makes it work: use **browser language** to decide *which language to suggest*, and **IP geolocation** to decide *region, currency and legal* — and **never auto-switch silently**. Detect, then ask, then remember.

1 Two questions, two signals

Two different questions — answered by different signals

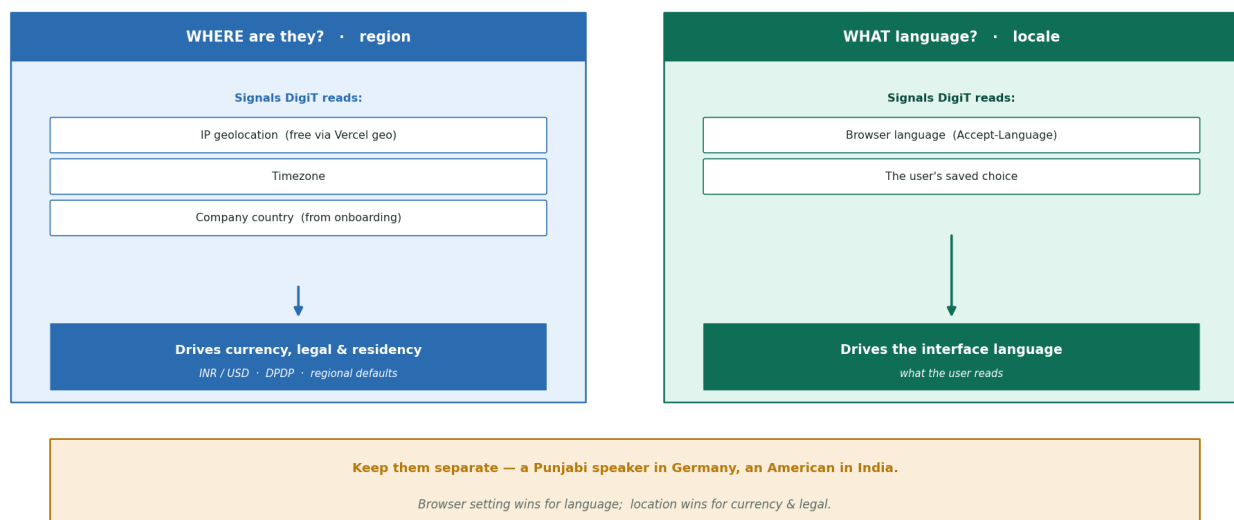


Figure 1 — Region and language are read from different signals and drive different things.

Every signal below is readable with **no permission prompt**:

- **Browser language** — the `Accept-Language` header / navigator . languages — what the user set as their preference (e.g. hi-IN, pa-IN, en-GB). The **best signal for language**, because it is a stated preference, not a guess.
- **IP geolocation** — maps their IP to a country / region — the **best signal for region** (currency, legal, residency), not language. On Vercel it is **free**: edge middleware exposes `request.geo` and an `x-vercel-ip-country` header, with zero setup.
- **Timezone** — from `Intl.DateTimeFormat().resolvedOptions().timeZone` (e.g. Asia/Kolkata) — a secondary hint that corroborates region.
- **The company's country** — already captured during onboarding verification, so a tenant has a sensible default locale before the user even picks.
- **The user's saved choice** — once they decide, it overrides everything on every future visit.

(Precise GPS via the Geolocation API exists too, but it needs explicit consent and is overkill here — do not use it for language.)

2 The decision — detect, ask, remember

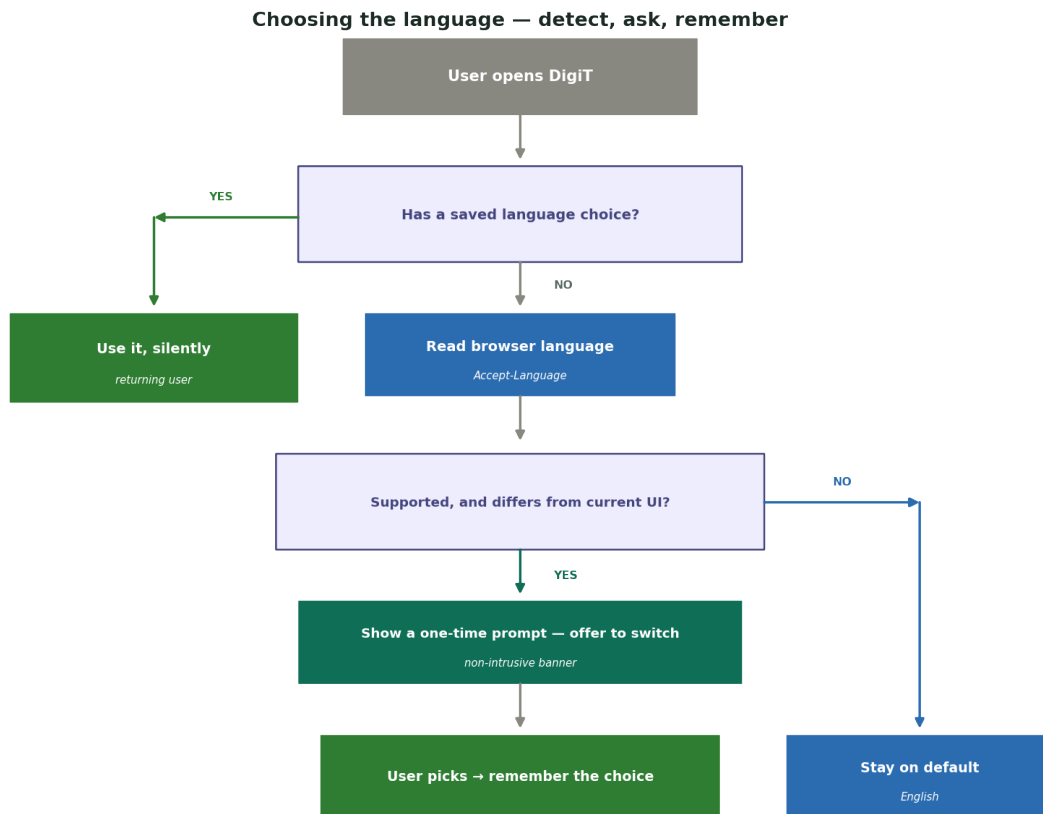


Figure 2 — The language decision. GeoIP is deliberately absent from it — location sets region and currency, never the language.

- **Priority order for language** — the user's **saved choice** wins; otherwise the **browser language** is used to suggest; otherwise the **default** (English).
- **Detect, don't impose** — on first visit DigiT compares the detected language to the current UI; if they differ and the language is supported, it offers to switch — it does not switch on its own.
- **Remember** — the choice is stored so the prompt never appears again.

3 The prompt — how it behaves

The language prompt

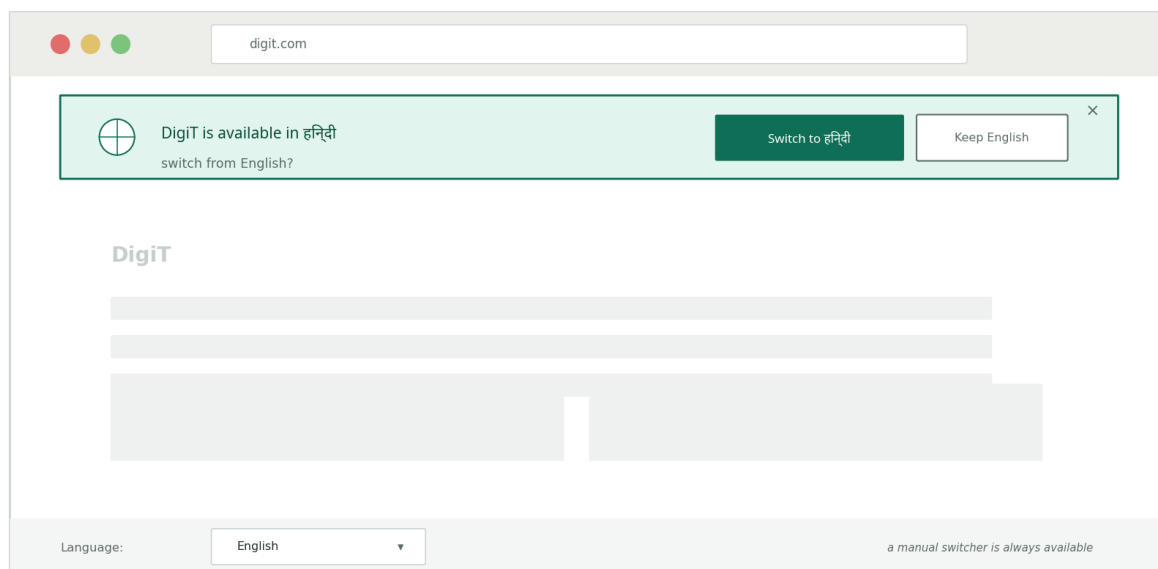


Figure 3 — A one-time, non-intrusive banner — not a blocking pop-up — with a manual switcher always available in the footer.

- **A banner, not a modal** — on first visit, if the detected language differs and is supported, DigiT shows a dismissible banner (“DigiT is available in Hindi — switch from English?”) — never a blocking pop-up.
- **It remembers** — the decision is saved to a `NEXT_LOCALE` cookie **and** the user's Supabase profile (so it syncs across their devices), and the prompt never appears again.
- **A manual switcher always stays** — in the footer or header, regardless — the prompt is a convenience, not the only path.
- **Graceful fallback** — if the detected language is not one DigiT supports yet, it stays on English and simply does not prompt.

4 For DigiT specifically

- **Next.js i18n routing** — Next.js has built-in internationalised routing — locale sub-paths like `/hi` or `/pa`, or a cookie-based approach.
- **Vercel geo at the edge** — the geo headers give you region before the page even renders.
- **Store the choice in the profile** — so it follows the user across devices and sessions.
- **A sensible starting set** — English (default), Hindi and Punjabi — expandable later as you grow.
- **Region does double duty** — the same region signal should also drive **INR-vs-USD pricing** (Razorpay vs Stripe) and **DPDP data residency** — both already in your specs.

5 One honest caution

Do not let GeoIP override a *stated* language preference. If someone's browser is set to English but they are connecting from India, **suggest** — do not force — Hindi. The browser setting wins for language; the location wins for currency and legal. Getting this backwards is exactly the mistake that annoys travelling and diaspora users.